

The layers appear in the order that their coloured time bars start. It's all also important to keep in mind here that the depth of layers is the order of elements on the left side of the Timeline panel, so a layer that is hidden behind another layer, will still not appear when its time-bar starts a bit later.

3) ANIMATING LAYERS

Animating elements will make things fun, interesting and engaging. While the final output of an animation might look pretty simple, the devil is in the details. Every little bit has to be carefully calculated and specified. Let's figure out how to make the logo fly at the beginning of our composition.

There's 2 main factors that have to be specified – When? And Where? (More specifically, from where?)

For our experiment, let's make it enter from the bottom of the screen at the beginning of the composition.

The current time indicator has to be the beginning of the timeline. Selecting a layer makes it 'the active layer'. Since we are animating the logo, let's choose the logo in the timeline panel to make it the active layer. Once you select it, you can see that the logo is also selected in the 'Composition' panel. With 8 markers on the periphery and one with cross hairs in the center for a total of 9 markers. Since, we're moving it in from the bottom, we first need to drag the logo to the bottom by clicking on it and dragging it in the Composition panel.

TIP: Holding the 'SHIFT' key while dragging it will move it in a straight line.

Make sure to drag the logo completely off the screen, otherwise you'll be left with a puzzling and unprofessional partial view of the logo at the beginning of the composition. Also don't push it too far off the screen, otherwise it'll be much harder to drag it back inside later on.

The next step is to signal to After Effects about the timing of movement and the start point of the logo.

- Click on the arrow to the left of the layer name and number in the Timeline panel. This will expand the Logo layer properties.
- You will get access to a single function called 'Transform' under the expansion. Click on the arrow to the 'left' of Logo to further expand it.
- This will give you access to a bunch of other properties like 'Anchor Point', 'Position', 'Scale', 'Rotation' and 'Opacity'.
- At the moment, we are only concerned with the 'Position' property.
- Click on the stop watch symbol next to 'Position'.

Once you do this, you can see that each of the properties has their own